



TRUSTMRR FULL DATASET · FROZEN 30 JUL 2026

The State of Indie & Micro-SaaS Revenue

A data-driven analysis of 8,782 startups tracked on TrustMRR — revenue, growth, categories, and what actually predicts who wins.

Prepared from the TrustMRR public revenue dataset

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A large, thriving — but extremely top-heavy — market

8,782

startups tracked in the dataset

\$15.4M

combined monthly recurring revenue

\$33.2M

combined trailing 30-day revenue

646,933

active paid subscriptions across all startups

- **Revenue is a lottery, not a bell curve.**

The top 1% of startups (87 companies) capture 69.5% of all MRR — the median startup earns \$0.

- **AI is the largest labeled category, but not the most efficient.**

1,430 AI startups generate \$2.25M MRR — leadership by volume, not by revenue-per-company.

- **Subscriber depth beats social reach.**

Active subscriptions correlate with MRR at 0.90 — X/Twitter followers barely move the needle (0.12).

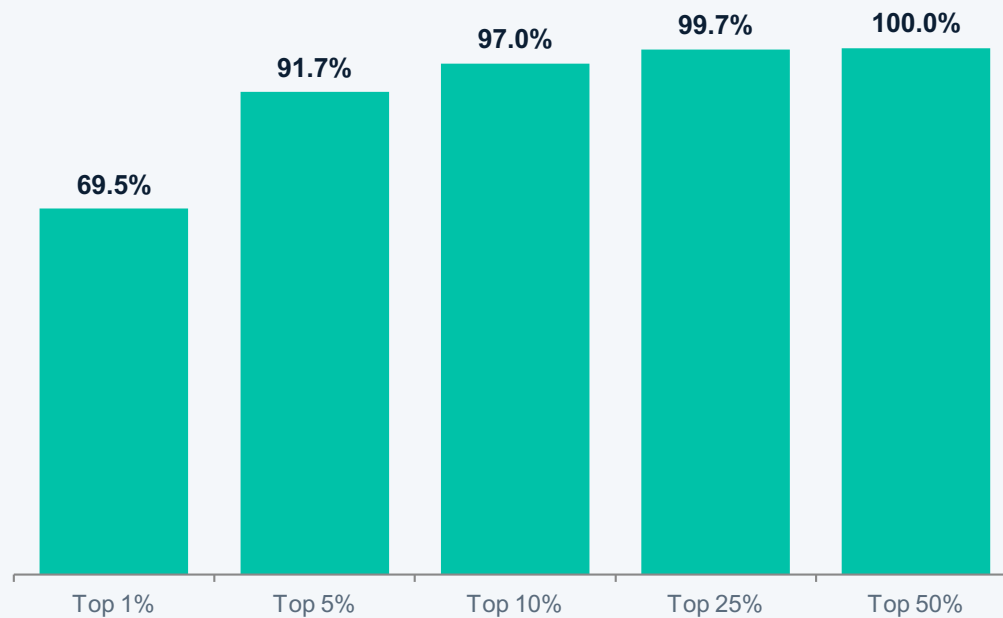
- **Nearly a quarter of listings are for sale.**

1,952 startups (22%) are on the market, at a median asking price of just \$5,000.

REVENUE DISTRIBUTION

Revenue is brutally concentrated at the top

Cumulative share of total MRR held by top X% of startups



57.2%

of all listed startups report exactly \$0 in monthly recurring revenue

\$1,752 vs \$0

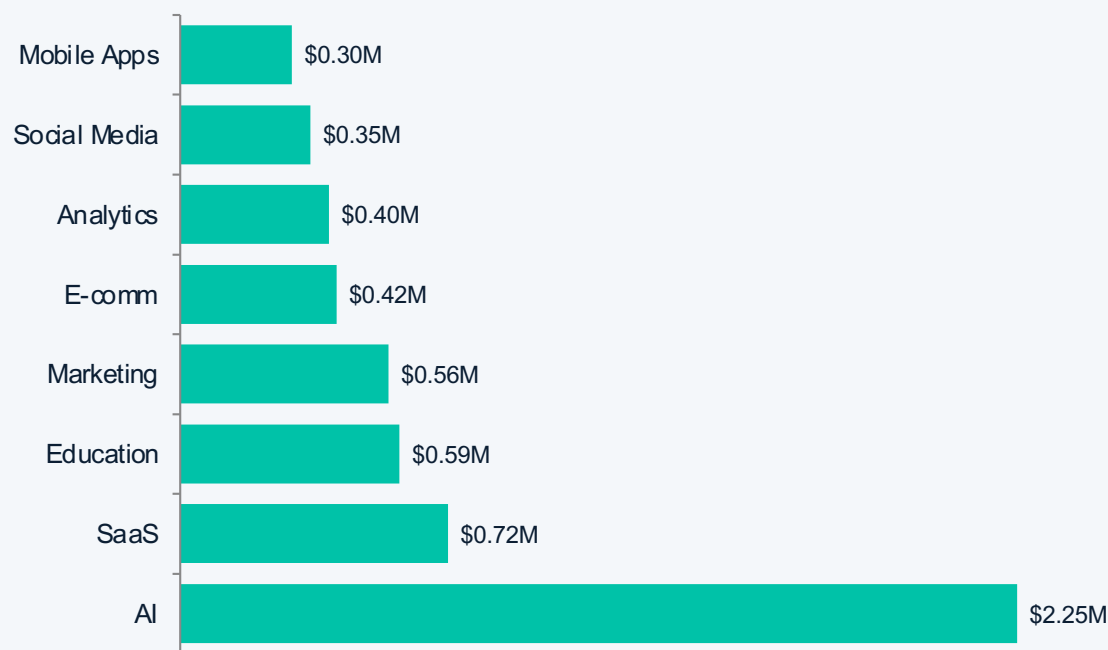
mean MRR vs. median MRR — the average is pulled entirely by a handful of outliers

How to read this: the bottom 50% of startups (4,391 companies) contribute effectively 0% of total MRR. The curve is 97% saturated by the top 10% alone — this is a hits-driven market, not a distributed one.

Source: TrustMRR full dataset, mrr_usd field, n = 8,782

CATEGORY LANDSCAPE

AI leads the pack — but the lead is about volume, not efficiency



AI's 1,430 startups (16% of the dataset) hold only 14.6% of total MRR — roughly proportional, not dominant. Niche categories like E-comm and Social Media monetize each company harder.

Chart covers the 5,518 startups (63%) with a disclosed category. The remaining 37% — worth more MRR than every category shown here combined — is examined next.

Avg. MRR per company

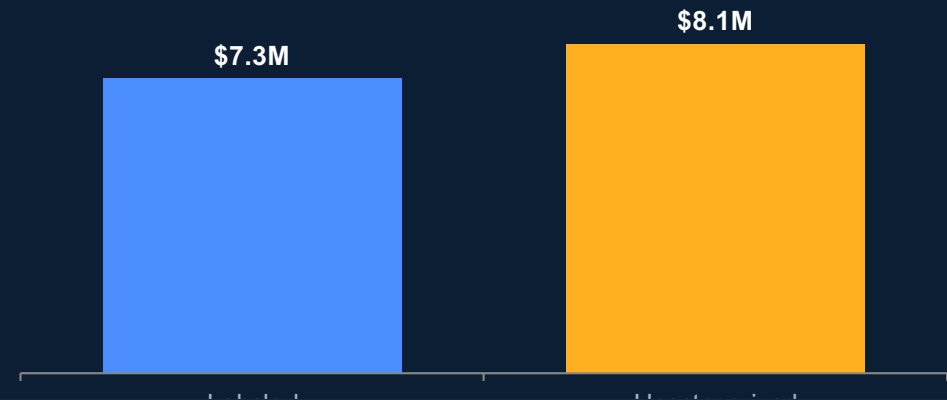
E-comm	\$4,168
Social Media	\$3,123
Analytics	\$2,878
Education	\$2,270
Marketing	\$1,750
AI	\$1,576
SaaS	\$1,366
Mobile Apps	\$1,050

DATA TRANSPARENCY

Over half the market's revenue is effectively invisible

\$8.1M

in combined MRR sits behind startups with no disclosed category — larger than every labeled category combined, including AI (\$2.25M).

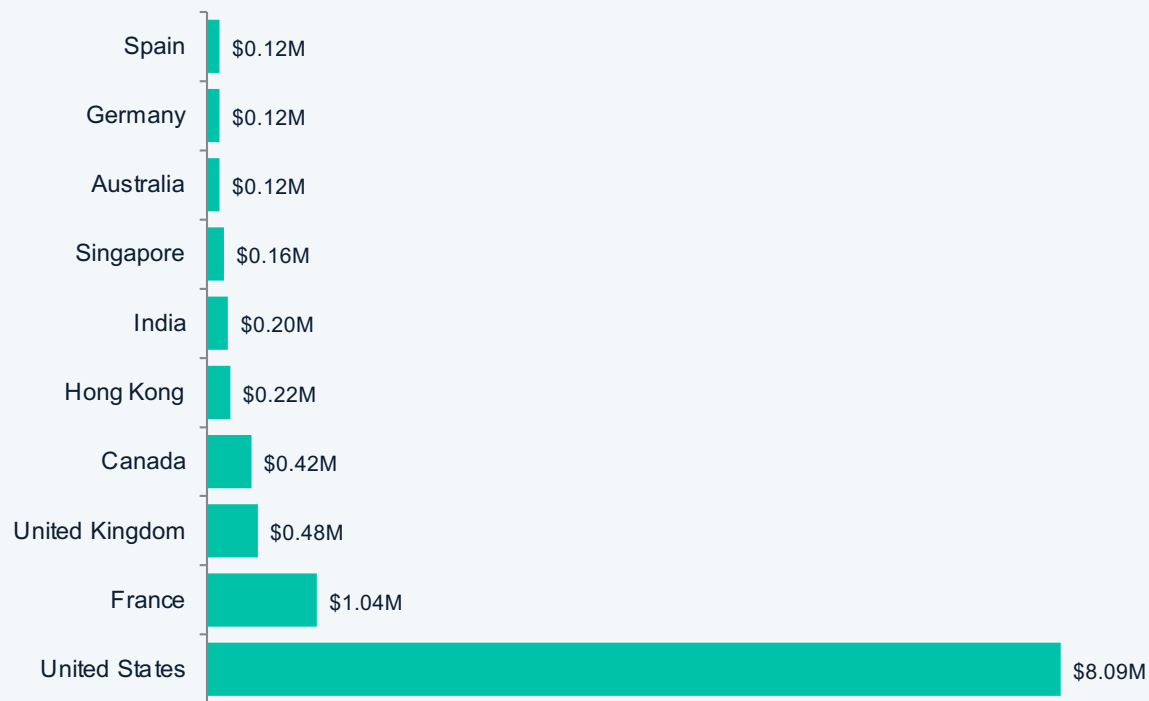


What's driving it

- 3,264 of 8,782 startups (37%) carry no category label — 498 of them are explicitly listed as "Stealth Company"
- Missing categorization isn't correlated with being small: this segment's average MRR (\$2,488) is actually above the labeled-category average
- For a platform built on the promise of trust and transparency, incomplete metadata on the highest-earning cohort is the single biggest gap in the dataset

GEOGRAPHY

The US anchors the market — everywhere else is long-tail



52.6%

of all disclosed MRR comes from the US alone —
1,657 startups

21.3%

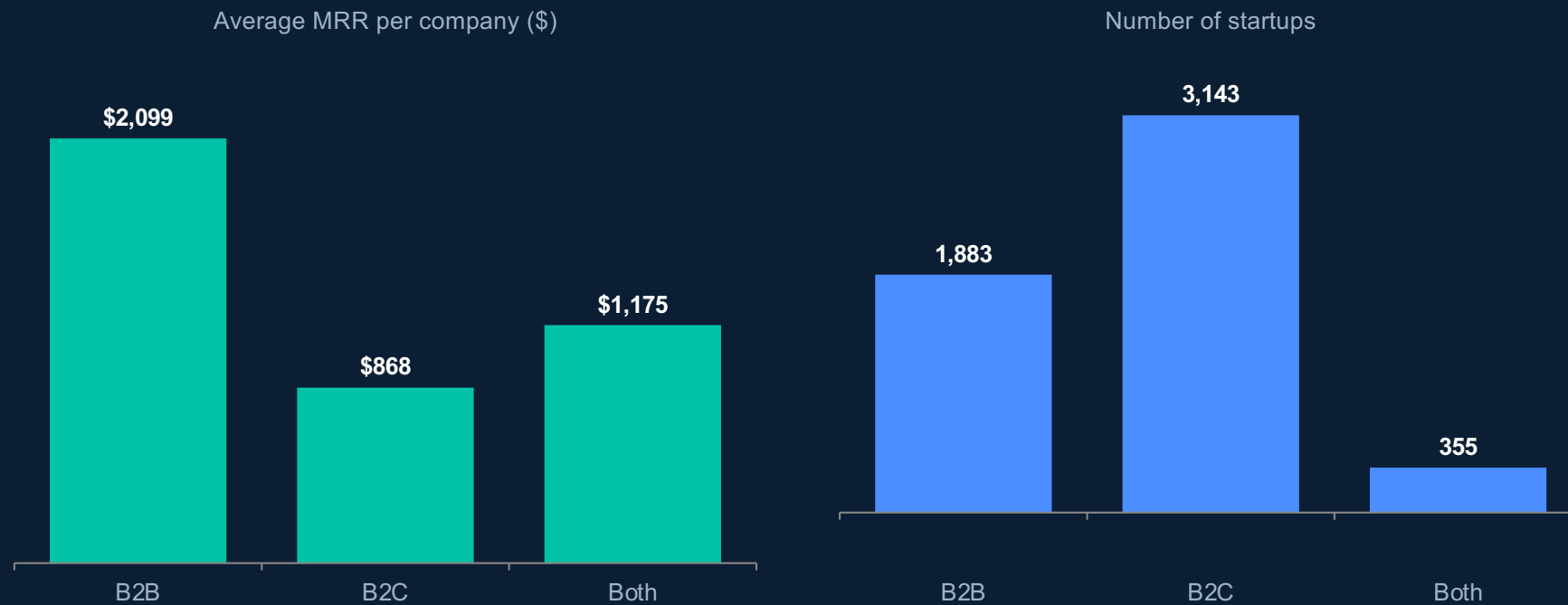
of startups (1,869) disclose no country — likely
stealth or early-stage

Long tail

France and the UK are distant #2 and #3; no other
single market exceeds 3% of total MRR

BUSINESS MODEL

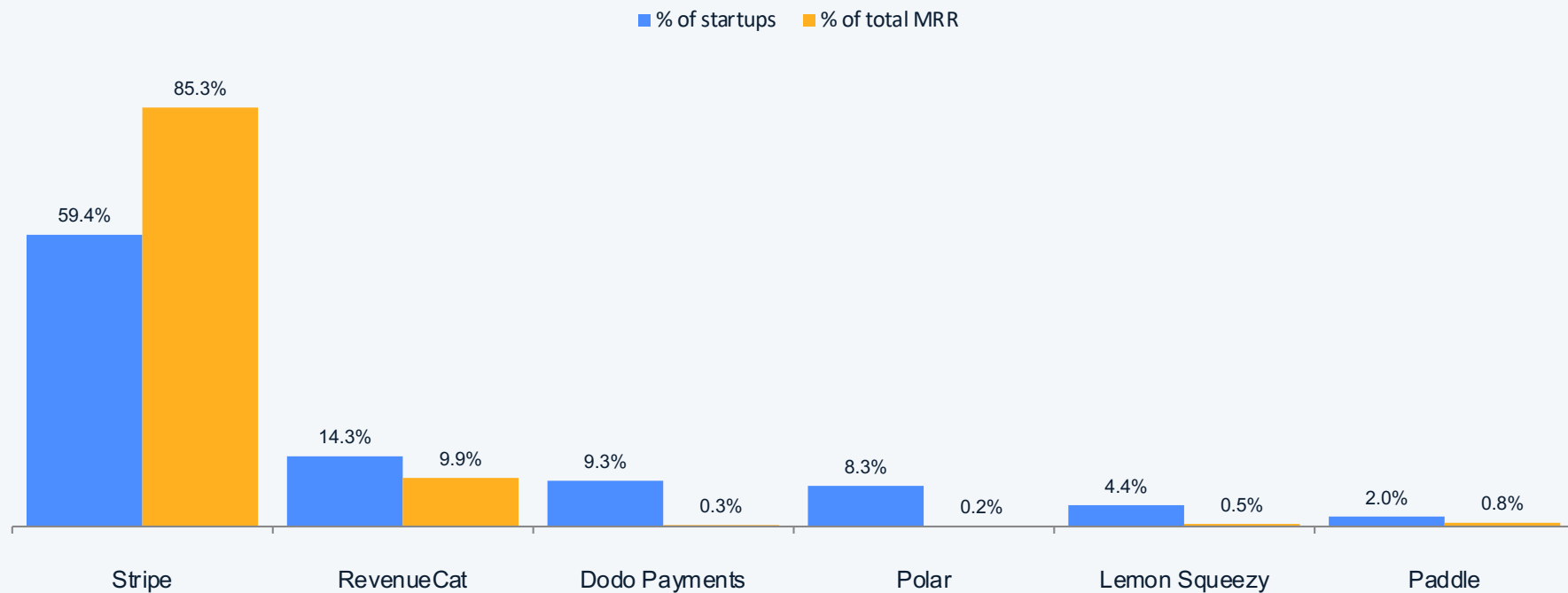
B2B startups are fewer in number but monetize far harder



B2C outnumbers B2B by 1,260 startups, yet B2B earns 2.4x more MRR per company on average — the classic willingness-to-pay gap between businesses and consumers.

PAYMENT INFRASTRUCTURE

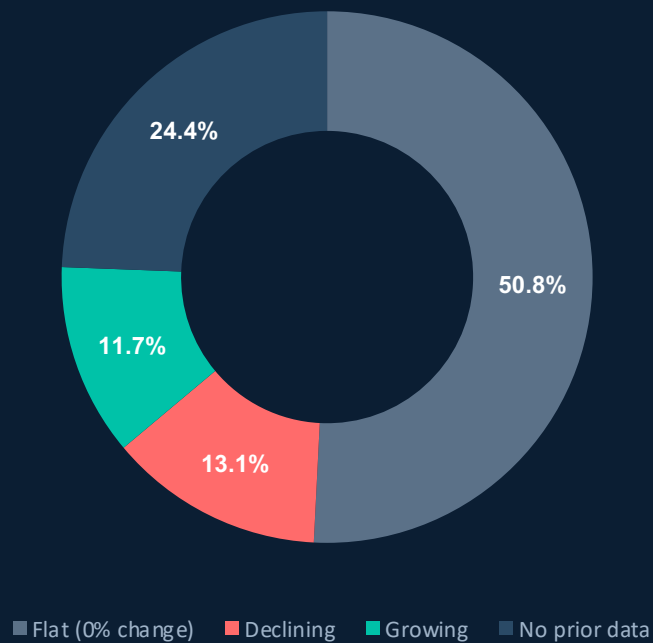
Stripe dominates where the revenue actually is



Dodo and Polar together power 17.6% of startups by count but just 0.5% of total MRR — a strong marker of an early-stage, indie-hacker builder segment not yet at scale.

GROWTH DYNAMICS

Most startups are flat — but the tails are wild



Sharpest 30-day movers (MRR > \$1,000)

TOP GAINERS

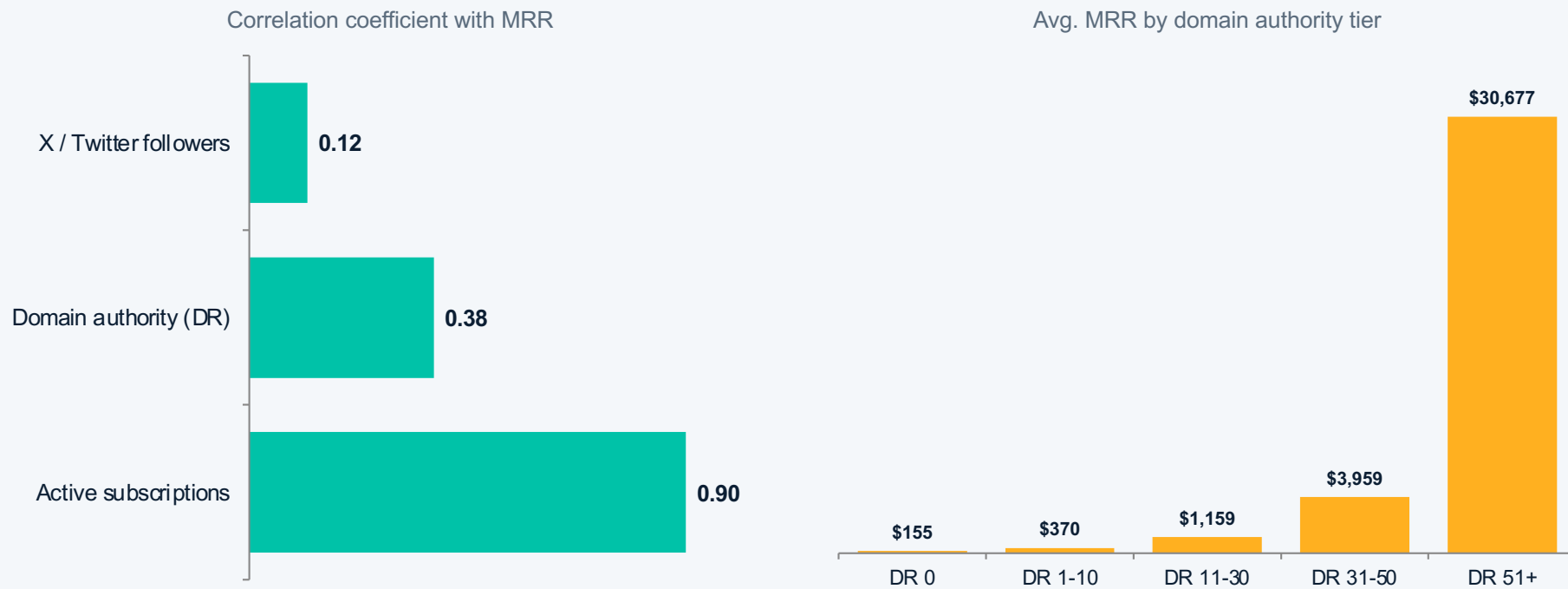
FirstRep	Health & Fitness	+10,300%
Hand-Off	E-comm	+4,965%
Hidden Jobs	Recruiting & HR	+1,357%
HotelHero.ai	AI	+1,227%

TOP DECLINERS

Barron Tech LLC	Sales	-82.2%
PipeLime	AI	-78.7%
Elofoot	AI	-71.5%
PolyPick	Fintech	-66.6%

REVENUE DRIVERS

Subscriber depth and site authority predict revenue — social reach doesn't



Startups with a domain rating of 51+ earn ~198x the average MRR of unranked domains — SEO and content authority compound revenue far more than audience size on social.

ACQUISITIONS

22% of the market is for sale — and it's priced like a garage sale

22.2%

of all startups (1,952) are currently listed for sale

\$5,000

median asking price across all listings

1.0x

median asking price as a multiple of trailing revenue

\$70,678

mean asking price — 14x the median, skewed by a few large listings

Notable listings

STARTUP	CATEGORY	ASKING PRICE	MULTIPLE
1Lookup	SaaS	\$10.0M	2.1x
Project A	Entertainment	\$5.0M	4.9x
POST BRIDGE	—	\$4.2M	8.2x
Launch Club	Marketing	\$3.0M	4.6x
LocalRank.so	Marketing	\$1.8M	5.7x

Takeaway

Most sellers are pricing small, pre-scale products near 1x revenue — real bargains exist for buyers willing to sift volume for quality.

LEADERBOARD

The ten highest-earning startups on TrustMRR

Rank	Startup	Category	MRR	30d Growth	Subscriptions
1	Stan	—	\$3,569,654	+0.4%	101,590
2	Stealth Company (undisclosed)	—	\$747,069	-74.3%	1,677
3	GojiberryAI	AI	\$494,668	+23.6%	4,642
4	Stealth Company (undisclosed)	—	\$364,101	+1.0%	2,134
5	Rezi	AI	\$259,701	-4.9%	10,749
6	Kibu	Education	\$234,319	+52.8%	375
7	Cometly	Analytics	\$207,616	+3.0%	307
8	1Lookup	SaaS	\$207,064	-7.5%	655
9	Stealth Company (France)	—	\$191,268	+2.4%	8,108
10	Brand On Demand, Inc.	E-comm	\$187,459	-1.8%	3,631

"Stealth Company" entries mask real startup names by platform design; category and identity remain undisclosed at source.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATIONS

Five takeaways for anyone building on — or buying from — this market

- 01 Ignore the average.**

With 57% of startups at \$0 MRR and the top 1% holding 69.5% of revenue, benchmark against medians and cohorts, never the mean.
- 02 Category size $\neq$ category efficiency.**

AI leads on headcount, but E-comm and Social Media startups earn 2-3x more revenue per company — pick a lane by unit economics, not hype.
- 03 Build authority, not just an audience.**

Domain rating correlates with MRR 3x more strongly than X followers — SEO and content compounding outperform social reach.
- 04 B2B still commands a premium.**

B2B startups earn 2.4x the average MRR of B2C peers despite being outnumbered — pricing power favors business buyers.
- 05 Undisclosed listings are the market's blind spot.**

\$8.1M in MRR sits behind unlabeled or stealth startups — more transparency here would materially improve buyer and benchmarking confidence.



Thank you

Analysis based on the TrustMRR full dataset, frozen 30 July 2026 (8,782 startups).
